BRIEFING NOTE | MINISTRY OF FOREIGN AFFAIRS AND MINISTRY OF TOURISM, WILDLIFE AND ANTIQUITIES

Film Diplomacy and Film Tourism

One-page summary of PGU Deliverable 6, Cultural and Diplomatic Assets Map (November 2026)

The point. Uganda's screen image abroad is set mostly by others: The African Queen at Murchison Falls (1951), The Last King of Scotland, Queen of Katwe, War/Dance. Uganda's own films reach Berlinale, Venice, Netflix and the AMVCAs, but no mission programme, tourism product or co-production treaty uses them. Two fixed windows open in 2027: **AFCON Pamoja 2027** (19 June to 17 July), with UTB as Official Destination Sponsor, and the **film diplomacy pilot** proposed for FY2027/28.

	What we found	What we ask
Missions (MoFA)	Mission cultural capacity is unconfirmed. The 2025 Economic and Commercial Diplomacy Strategy Handbook names tourism, not culture or film. Remittances were US$2.5bn in 2025.	Approve a three-mission Uganda film week pilot in FY2027/28 (Nairobi, London, Pretoria proposed; UGX 20m per event, about UGX 60m). PGU convenes a slate panel; MoFA decides.
Treaties (MoFA)	No audiovisual co-production treaty found. A South Africa treaty was raised in 2021. Uganda ratified the 2005 UNESCO Convention and the Beijing Treaty (in force 2022).	Confirm treaty status in writing. Open exploratory talks with an EAC partner and South Africa.
Archives (MoFA, MGLSD)	Colonial-era film of Uganda sits in UK collections (IWM, BFI and others). The Uganda Film Unit reels (c.1947 to 1981) are being digitised under a 2025 to 2028 UK-Australian project with UBC.	Seek access copies and fee waivers for Ugandan non-commercial use. Settle custody and rights of the Film Unit reels and secure a master copy in Uganda.
Locations (MTWA, UWA)	10 national parks, 3 World Heritage sites, 15 gazetted sites and monuments. UWA filming tariff not published in current form. The Museums and Monuments Act 2023 is silent on filming.	Publish the UWA tariff and form. One film permit desk for parks, museums and monuments under the MTWA-PGU MOU. Filming regulations for gazetted sites.
Film tourism (MTWA, UTB)	Explore Uganda (2022) emphasises people and cities. No film is linked to it. The MTWA-PGU MOU (location database, Task Force) awaits signature on PGU's file.	Sign and resource the MOU. Two route pilots in 2027: the Nile route and a Kampala screen trail. AFCON 2027 content package commissioned by Q1 2027.
Communities	Most heritage is held by communities and cultural institutions without statutory screen-use terms.	Require PGU's Cultural Use Protocol for any site access, promotion or funding.

Budget link. D7 Strategy: film diplomacy I18 UGX 603m over five years; film tourism I17 UGX 2,058m; audiovisual heritage I22 UGX 2,550m. Validation of the map: UGX 230m to 395m in 2027. **Contact:** Geoffrey Ekongot, CEO, National Producers Guild of Uganda.